

ENGLISH COMMUNICATION & COGNITIVE ASSESSMENT

Complete Basic → Advanced Guide with Samples, Practice Sets & Tips

Companion to your Capgemini Exceller 2027 Prep Guide

Part	Covers
A — English Communication	Grammar, Reading Comprehension, Listening, Speaking, Formal Email, Informal Email, Sentence/Conclusion Questions
B — Cognitive & Game-Based	Motion Reasoning, Grid/Spatial Memory, Logical Reasoning, Behavioural (SJT), Pattern & Speed-Recognition Games

Every topic below is built basic → intermediate → advanced, with worked samples, timed practice sets with answers, and section-specific tips and tricks.

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PART A — ENGLISH COMMUNICATION

This part builds every English Communication sub-skill from the ground up. Work through each topic in order — Grammar underpins everything else (reading, writing, and even speaking accuracy), so start there.

A1 Grammar — Basic to Advanced

BASIC LEVEL

Subject–Verb Agreement

The verb must match the number (singular/plural) of its subject.

- Singular subject → singular verb: *"The manager approves the report."*
- Plural subject → plural verb: *"The managers approve the report."*
- Watch for words between subject and verb — they don't change agreement: *"The list of items **is** long"* (not 'are'; subject is 'list', not 'items').
- Collective nouns (team, staff, family) usually take a singular verb: *"The team is ready."*

Tenses — the Core 6 (Basic)

Tense	Structure	Example
Simple Present	subject + verb(s/es)	She works every day.
Present Continuous	am/is/are + verb-ing	She is working right now.
Simple Past	verb (2nd form)	She worked yesterday.
Past Continuous	was/were + verb-ing	She was working at 5 PM.
Simple Future	will + verb	She will work tomorrow.
Future Continuous	will be + verb-ing	She will be working at noon.

Articles (a / an / the)

- "A" before consonant **sounds**: a university (sounds like 'yoo'), a one-rupee coin.
- "An" before vowel **sounds**: an hour (silent h), an MBA (sounds like 'em').
- "The" for specific/already-known things: "the report I sent you."
- No article for general plural/uncountable nouns: "Honesty is important" (not "The honesty").

INTERMEDIATE LEVEL

Perfect Tenses

Tense	Structure	Use	Example
Present Perfect	have/has + V3	Past action with present relevance	I have completed the task.
Past Perfect	had + V3	Action before another past action	I had finished before he called.
Future Perfect	will have + V3	Action completed by a future point	I will have finished by 5 PM.

Prepositions — Commonly Confused Pairs

- **In / On / At** (time): in a month/year, on a specific day/date, at a specific time. "in May", "on Monday", "at 5 PM".
- **Since / For**: since + a point in time ("since 2020"), for + a duration ("for 3 years").
- **Between / Among**: between two things, among three or more.
- **Beside / Besides**: beside = next to; besides = in addition to.

Active vs Passive Voice

Passive voice shifts focus from the doer to the action/receiver. Formula: **object + be-verb + V3 (+ by + subject)**.

- Active: "The manager approved the report."
- Passive: "The report was approved by the manager."
- Use passive when the doer is unknown/unimportant: "The bridge was built in 1990."

Direct vs Indirect (Reported) Speech

- Direct: She said, "I am busy today."
- Indirect: She said (that) she was busy that day. — **Tense shifts back one step** (present→past), and time/place words change: today→that day, tomorrow→the next day, here→there.

ADVANCED LEVEL

Conditionals (If-clauses)

Type	Structure	Meaning	Example
Zero	If + present, present	General truth/fact	If you heat water, it boils.
First	If + present, will + verb	Real future possibility	If it rains, we will cancel the trip.
Second	If + past, would + verb	Hypothetical/unlikely present	If I had more time, I would help.
Third	If + past perfect, would have + V3	Hypothetical past (didn't happen)	If I had known, I would have come.

Subjunctive Mood & Tricky Modals

- Formal wishes/recommendations use base form: "It is essential that he **submit** the report" (not 'submits').
- "Wish" + past for present regret: "I wish I knew the answer." "Wish" + past perfect for past regret: "I wish I had studied."
- **Modals of deduction:** must (certain), might/could (possible), can't (impossible certainty) — "He can't have left already; his car is still here."

Parallelism & Sentence Structure

Items in a list/comparison must share the same grammatical form.

- Incorrect: "She likes reading, to write, and painting."
- Correct: "She likes reading, writing, and painting." (all -ing forms)

A1.4 Grammar Practice Set (Mixed Difficulty)

Q1. Choose the correct sentence:

✓ **Answer: "Neither of the employees was informed about the change."**

Why: "Neither... nor... / neither of" takes a singular verb even though it refers to two people.

Q2. Fill in the blank: "He _____ in this company since 2019."

(A) works (B) is working (C) has been working (D) worked

✓ **Answer: (C) has been working**

Why: "Since + a point in time" with an action continuing to now requires present perfect continuous.

Q3. Identify the error: "Each of the students have submitted their assignment."

✓ **Answer: "have" should be "has"**

Why: "Each of" is always followed by a singular verb, regardless of the plural noun that follows.

Q4. Convert to passive: "They are painting the house."

✓ **Answer: "The house is being painted (by them)."**

Why: Present continuous passive formula: object + is/are + being + V3.

Q5. Choose the correct conditional: "If she _____ harder, she would have passed."

(A) studies (B) studied (C) had studied (D) would study

✓ **Answer: (C) had studied**

Why: Third conditional (hypothetical past) requires 'if + past perfect' in the if-clause.

Q6. Convert to indirect speech: He said, "I will call you tomorrow."

✓ **Answer: "He said (that) he would call me the next day."**

Why: Will→would (tense backshift) and tomorrow→the next day (time-reference shift) in reported speech.

Q7. Spot the error: "Besides being late, he was also improperly dressed for the meeting."

✓ **Answer: No error — this sentence is correct.**

Why: A quick trap question: this tests whether you can recognise a CORRECT parallel and idiomatic sentence rather than always assuming there's a mistake.

Q8. Choose the correct modal: "You _____ have locked the door; it's wide open now."

(A) must (B) can't (C) should (D) might

✓ **Answer: (B) can't**

Why: "Can't have + V3" expresses certainty that something did NOT happen — logically fits with the door being open.

■ Grammar Tips & Tricks

When two options both sound 'grammatically fine', pick the one that matches the **exact tense/time clue** in the sentence (since, for, tomorrow, yesterday, by the time...).

For subject-verb agreement traps, mentally delete the phrase between subject and verb to isolate the true subject.

For error-spotting questions, read the sentence in parts (subject / verb / object / modifiers) rather than as one block — errors usually hide at the joins.

Don't overcorrect — some sentences ARE grammatically correct; don't force an error where none exists.

A2 Reading Comprehension

STRATEGY BASICS

- **Skim first (30–45 sec):** read the first and last sentence of each paragraph to grasp the overall structure before reading questions.
- **Read the questions before the full passage** when time is short — this tells you exactly what to hunt for.
- **Distinguish 'stated' vs 'inferred':** some questions ask what the passage directly says; others ask what it implies — don't import outside knowledge into either.
- **Vocabulary-in-context questions:** ignore the dictionary meaning you know — find the meaning that fits the specific sentence.

INTERMEDIATE — COMMON QUESTION TYPES

Question type	What it asks	How to approach
Main idea / title	Overall theme of the passage	Look at the first + last paragraph; avoid options that cover only ONE detail
Detail/fact-based	A specific stated fact	Scan for keywords from the question; the answer is usually a close paraphrase, not exact words
Inference	What's implied but not directly stated	Base it strictly on passage logic — don't add outside assumptions
Tone/attitude	Author's feeling (critical, neutral, approving...)	Look at adjectives and word choice throughout, not just one line
Vocabulary-in-context	Meaning of a word AS USED here	Re-read the sentence with each option substituted in

ADVANCED — TRAPS TO WATCH FOR

- **Extreme-language traps:** options with "always", "never", "completely" are often wrong even if the general idea is right — passages are rarely that absolute.
- **Partially-true options:** an option can be half-correct but wrong overall because of one added false detail — read the whole option, not just the first half.
- **Opposite-meaning distractors:** designed to catch skimmers who match keywords without reading meaning.

A2.4 Sample Passage & Practice Questions

Passage (Practice)

Remote work, once considered a temporary pandemic-era arrangement, has settled into a permanent feature of many industries. Companies that initially resisted flexible arrangements have found that productivity, contrary to early fears, often improved when employees were given autonomy over their schedules. However, this shift has not been without challenges: team cohesion and spontaneous collaboration — the kind that once happened over a coffee break — have proven harder to replicate virtually. Many organisations are now experimenting with hybrid models, requiring in-person attendance for a few days a week specifically to preserve these informal interactions, while retaining the flexibility employees have come to value.

Q1. What is the main idea of the passage?

(A) Remote work has failed everywhere (B) Companies are moving to a hybrid balance between flexibility and in-person collaboration (C) Productivity always decreases with remote work (D) Coffee breaks are essential to every company

✓ **Answer: (B)**

Why: The passage discusses both the benefits (productivity, flexibility) and the challenge (collaboration), concluding with the hybrid-model compromise — matching option B; A and C are extreme/false, D is a minor detail.

Q2. According to the passage, why do companies require some in-person days?

✓ **Answer: To preserve informal interactions and team cohesion that are hard to replicate virtually.**

Why: This is a direct detail-based question — the passage explicitly states this reason.

Q3. The word 'cohesion' in the passage most nearly means:

(A) confusion (B) unity/togetherness (C) competition (D) distance

✓ **Answer: (B) unity/togetherness**

Why: Vocabulary-in-context: 'team cohesion... harder to replicate virtually' implies the bonding/unity aspect of teams.

Q4. What can be inferred about the companies' initial attitude toward flexible work?

✓ **Answer: They were initially skeptical/resistant, expecting productivity to drop.**

Why: Inference from 'Companies that initially resisted... contrary to early fears' — implies they expected a negative outcome.

■ Reading Comprehension Tips

Underline (mentally or on scratch paper) names, numbers, and contrast words ("however", "but", "although") — these usually mark where questions are drawn from.

If two options seem equally correct, re-check for one word that makes one of them too extreme or slightly inaccurate.

Manage time: don't re-read the entire passage for every question — go back to the relevant paragraph only.

A3 Listening

FORMAT & BASICS

You'll typically hear a short audio clip (a conversation, announcement, or monologue) once or twice, then answer questions or repeat/transcribe what you heard.

- **Predict before listening:** if a question/topic is shown first, think about likely vocabulary before the audio starts.
- **Note-taking:** jot key nouns, numbers, and names as you hear them — don't try to write full sentences.
- **First listen = gist, second listen (if allowed) = details.**

INTERMEDIATE — HANDLING DIFFERENT ACCENTS & SPEEDS

- Practice with varied English accents (British, American, Indian-English professional tone) using news podcasts — Capgemini's audio is usually neutral/professional, not heavily regional.
- Focus on stressed words in a sentence (usually nouns/verbs) — these carry the core meaning even if you miss small connector words.
- If a number or name is spoken quickly, listen for the surrounding context to double check (e.g., "fifteen" vs "fifty" — listen for stress pattern).

ADVANCED — REPEAT/DICTATION STYLE QUESTIONS

- For 'repeat the sentence' tasks: don't try to memorize word-for-word if the sentence is long — instead grasp the MEANING and chunk it into 2–3 logical phrases, then reconstruct.
- For dictation/fill-in-the-blank listening: pay special attention to verb tense and singular/plural — these are the most commonly tested details.

A3.4 Sample Practice (Transcript-Based)

 Imagine you hear this short audio clip once:

"Good morning, everyone. Today's client review meeting has been moved from 11 AM to 2 PM in Conference Room B, due to a scheduling conflict with the Mumbai team. Please make sure the revised deck is shared with all attendees at least thirty minutes before the meeting."

Q1. What time was the meeting originally scheduled for?

✓ **Answer: 11 AM**

Why: Direct detail — always note original AND new time when a change is mentioned; these are the most commonly tested details in listening clips.

Q2. Where will the meeting now be held?

✓ **Answer: Conference Room B**

Why: Direct detail recall.

Q3. What must be done thirty minutes before the meeting?

✓ **Answer: The revised deck must be shared with all attendees.**

Why: Tests whether you caught the final instruction, not just the schedule change — listening questions often end with an action item.

■ Listening Tips

Numbers, times, and names are tested most often — give them your fullest attention over general narrative details.

If you miss one detail, don't panic and lose focus on the rest of the clip — keep listening; most questions are independent of each other.

Practice daily with 5–10 minutes of English news audio, pausing every 30 seconds to mentally summarize what was just said.

A4 Speaking

SUB-TYPES YOU'LL LIKELY FACE

Task type	What happens	Time given
Read Aloud	A sentence/paragraph appears on screen — read it clearly	20–40 sec prep + reading
Repeat Sentence	Hear a sentence once, repeat it exactly	Immediate, no prep
Describe an Image	Describe what you see in a picture/chart	30–45 sec to speak
Answer a Short Question	Quick one-word/short-phrase reflex answers	~10 sec each
Retell/Summarize	Listen to a short passage, summarize in your own words	30–60 sec to speak
Opinion/Open Question	Give your view on a general topic	45–60 sec to speak

BASIC — FLUENCY & CLARITY FOUNDATIONS

- Speak at a natural, conversational pace — around 120–150 words per minute is ideal, not rushed, not painfully slow.
- Enunciate word endings fully (don't drop 't', 'd', 's' sounds) — AI scoring engines weigh clarity heavily.
- Breathe at natural pause points (commas, end of clauses) rather than mid-word.

INTERMEDIATE — STRUCTURE FOR OPINION/DESCRIBE TASKS

Use a simple 3-part structure so you never run out of things to say:

- **1. State your point/what you see** in one sentence.
- **2. Give 1–2 supporting details or reasons.**
- **3. Close with a brief conclusion or takeaway.**

 **Sample prompt: "Describe a challenge you recently overcame." (model answer structure)**

"One challenge I recently overcame was managing multiple deadlines during my final semester. *(point)* I created a priority list and broke each task into smaller daily goals, which helped me stay on track without feeling overwhelmed. *(supporting detail)* In the end, I submitted everything on time and learned how valuable structured planning is under pressure. *(conclusion)*"

ADVANCED — HANDLING UNFAMILIAR/DIFFICULT PROMPTS

- If you don't immediately know what to say, buy 2–3 seconds with a natural filler phrase ("That's an interesting question...", "Let me think about that for a moment...") rather than going silent — but don't overuse fillers.
- If you make a grammar mistake mid-sentence, briefly self-correct and keep going smoothly rather than restarting from scratch — this shows real-world communication skill, not perfection.
- For 'repeat sentence' tasks with long/complex sentences, focus on getting the core meaning and key details (numbers, names) right even if the exact wording isn't perfect.

■ Speaking Tips & Tricks

Use your FULL allotted time — very short answers (5–10 seconds when 45 are given) score lower on content, even if grammatically perfect.

Record yourself daily on your phone and play it back — you'll immediately notice pacing and filler-word habits you don't notice while speaking live.

Test your mic setup and sit in a silent room — background noise can lower your clarity score regardless of how well you actually speak.

Smile slightly while speaking (even though it's audio-based) — it naturally improves your tone and reduces monotone delivery.

A5 Formal Email Writing

STRUCTURE (Basic)

- **Subject line:** short, specific, no vague titles like "Update" — use "Update: Client Meeting Rescheduled to 3 PM".
- **Greeting:** "Dear Mr./Ms. [Surname]," or "Dear Team," for a group.
- **Opening line:** state the purpose immediately — don't bury it in paragraph two.
- **Body:** 2–4 short paragraphs, one idea per paragraph.
- **Closing:** a clear next step or ask, followed by "Best regards," / "Sincerely," + your name.

USEFUL FORMAL PHRASE BANK (Intermediate)

Purpose	Useful phrase
Opening	"I am writing to inform you that..." / "I am reaching out regarding..."
Requesting	"I would appreciate it if you could..." / "Could you kindly provide..."
Apologizing	"I apologize for any inconvenience this may cause."
Attaching something	"Please find attached the requested document."
Closing with action	"Please let me know if you have any questions." / "I look forward to your response."

ADVANCED — TONE CALIBRATION

- Avoid contractions in formal writing ("do not" not "don't", "I am" not "I'm").
- Avoid overly casual connectors ("So basically...", "Anyway...") — replace with "Therefore," "In addition," "However,".
- Keep requests polite but direct — excessive hedging ("I was just wondering if maybe possibly...") reads as unprofessional, not polite.

A5.4 Sample Formal Emails

Sample 1 — Requesting a deadline extension

Subject: Request for Extension on Project Submission

Dear Mr. Sharma,

I am writing to request a short extension on the submission deadline for the Q3 analysis report, currently due this Friday.

Due to an unexpected delay in receiving data from the finance team, I anticipate needing two additional working days to ensure the report's accuracy. I am confident I can deliver a complete and well-reviewed submission by Tuesday, October 7th.

Please let me know if this timeline works on your end, or if there is any way I can assist in expediting the process.

Best regards,
Aarav Mehta

Sample 2 — Escalating a technical issue

Subject: Urgent: Recurring Login Issue Affecting Team Access

Dear IT Support Team,

I am writing to report a recurring login issue affecting several members of my team since yesterday morning. Users are receiving an "authentication failed" error despite entering correct credentials.

This is impacting our ability to access shared project files and meet today's deadlines. Could you please look into this on priority and advise on next steps?

I am happy to provide screenshots or arrange a quick call if that would help diagnose the issue faster.

Thank you for your prompt attention to this matter.

Sincerely,
Priya Nair

■ Formal Email Tips & Tricks

State your ask/purpose in the FIRST sentence — graders and real readers both lose patience with buried requests.

Keep paragraphs to 2–4 sentences each; a wall of text reads as poorly organized even if the grammar is fine.

Always end with a clear next step (what you want the reader to do) — don't just trail off after explaining the situation.

Proofread for tone consistency — don't mix a formal opening with a casual sign-off like "Thanks!" or "Cheers".

A6 Informal Email Writing

STRUCTURE (Basic)

- **Greeting:** "Hi [Name]," or "Hey [Name]," — first names only, no titles.
- **Tone:** conversational and warm, contractions are fine ("I'm", "don't", "let's").
- **Closing:** "Thanks!", "Talk soon,", "Cheers," + first name only.

INTERMEDIATE — KEEPING IT NATURAL

- Short sentences and natural connectors ("Also,", "By the way,", "Anyway,") are appropriate here — unlike formal email.
- It's fine to ask casual follow-up questions ("How's everything going on your end?") to keep a friendly tone.

ADVANCED — MATCHING TONE TO RELATIONSHIP

- Informal ≠ sloppy: even casual emails should have clear structure and correct grammar — 'informal' refers to TONE, not carelessness.
- Match energy to context: an informal email to a close colleague about weekend plans can be very casual; an informal-but-professional note to a semi-familiar contact should stay warm but slightly more measured.

A6.4 Sample Informal Emails

Sample 1 — Inviting a colleague to a casual team lunch

Subject: Lunch this Friday? ■

Hey Rohan,

A few of us are planning to grab lunch this Friday to celebrate wrapping up the project — thought you'd want in!

We're thinking that new place near the office around 1 PM. Let me know if you're free, and feel free to bring anyone else from the team along.

Hope to see you there!

Thanks,
Simran

Sample 2 — Asking a friend for a quick favor

Subject: Quick favor — got 5 mins?

Hi Aisha,

Hope you're doing well! I was wondering if you could help me review a short presentation before I send it to the client tomorrow — just want a second pair of eyes on the flow.

It's only about 6 slides, so shouldn't take more than 10–15 minutes whenever you get a chance today.

Really appreciate it — happy to return the favor anytime!

Thanks so much,
Dev

■ Informal Email Tips & Tricks

Even in informal emails, avoid slang that could be misread in a professional/test context — stay 'casual-professional' rather than fully colloquial.

Keep the same basic shape as formal email (greeting → purpose → close) — only the WORD CHOICE and tone shift, not the underlying structure.

If the assessment is scoring grammar too, don't let 'informal' become an excuse for sloppy sentences — casual tone with correct grammar is the target.

A7 Sentence Completion & Statement–Conclusion Questions

This topic covers two related but distinct question styles that often appear under 'verbal reasoning': (1) **Sentence Completion** — choosing the word/phrase that logically and grammatically completes a sentence, and (2) **Statement & Conclusion** — given a statement, deciding which conclusion(s) logically follow.

SENTENCE COMPLETION — BASICS

- Read the **WHOLE** sentence first — the answer often depends on a clue later in the sentence, not just the blank's immediate neighbours.
- Watch for contrast words ("although", "however", "despite") and continuation words ("and", "moreover") — they tell you whether the missing word should agree with or oppose the rest of the sentence.
- Eliminate options that are grammatically wrong first (wrong part of speech, wrong tense), then choose by meaning.

Sentence Completion — Practice

Q1. "Despite the heavy rainfall, the outdoor event was _____ as scheduled."

(A) cancelled (B) postponed (C) held (D) delayed

✓ **Answer: (C) held**

Why: "Despite" signals a contrast — the event happened *DESPITE* the rain, so it must have gone ahead as planned, not been cancelled/postponed/delayed.

Q2. "The new policy was met with _____ from employees, who felt it undermined their autonomy."

(A) enthusiasm (B) resistance (C) indifference (D) approval

✓ **Answer: (B) resistance**

Why: "Undermined their autonomy" is negative, so the reaction described (word before the comma) must also be negative — only 'resistance' fits.

Q3. "Although the report was thorough, it was _____ too technical for a general audience."

(A) surprisingly (B) barely (C) perhaps (D) rarely

✓ **Answer: (C) perhaps**

Why: The sentence is offering a mild, hedged criticism after praising the report ('although thorough') — 'perhaps' matches this softened, tentative tone better than the other options.

STATEMENT–CONCLUSION — BASICS

You are given one or more statements (treated as **TRUE**, even if they seem unusual) and must decide which conclusion(s) logically and definitely follow — not just conclusions that seem 'likely' or 'possible'.

- A conclusion follows only if it is a **necessary, certain** result of the statement(s) — not a common-sense guess.
- Don't use outside/general knowledge to judge a conclusion — judge it **PURELY** based on the given statement, even if the statement sounds odd.
- Watch for conclusions that are 'probably true' but not **GUARANTEED** — these are traps designed to catch over-eager reasoning.

Statement–Conclusion — Practice

Q1. Statement: "All engineers in the company have completed the safety training." Conclusion: "Everyone who has completed the safety training is an engineer."

Follows Does not follow

✓ **Answer: Does not follow**

Why: The statement only says engineers→trained (one direction). It does *NOT* say trained→engineer. Other non-engineers could also have completed the training — classic reversed-logic trap.

Q2. Statement: "If the server load exceeds 90%, an alert is triggered automatically." Conclusion: "An alert was triggered, so the server load must have exceeded 90%."

Follows Does not follow

✓ **Answer: Does not follow**

Why: The statement only guarantees one direction ($\text{load} > 90\% \rightarrow \text{alert}$). Other conditions might also trigger an alert; we can't conclude the reverse with certainty.

Q3. Statement: "Every employee who joined before 2020 is eligible for the legacy pension plan." Conclusion: "Someone who joined in 2018 is eligible for the legacy pension plan."

Follows Does not follow

✓ **Answer: Follows**

Why: 2018 is before 2020, so this is a direct, certain application of the given rule — this **DOES** logically follow.

■ Sentence Completion & Statement-Conclusion Tips

For sentence completion: identify whether the sentence needs a word that **AGREES** or **CONTRASTS** with the rest — this eliminates half the options instantly.

For statement-conclusion: draw a simple arrow diagram ($A \rightarrow B$) for the statement, then check if the conclusion matches that exact direction or reverses it.

Never assume real-world plausibility matters — treat the given statement as gospel truth, however strange, and reason only from it.

If a conclusion uses stronger language than the statement (e.g., statement says 'may', conclusion says 'will'), it almost always does **NOT** follow.

PART B — COGNITIVE & GAME-BASED ASSESSMENT

This part covers the puzzle/game-style sections that test raw reasoning speed and pattern recognition rather than learned knowledge. These are highly trainable with practice — the same handful of patterns repeat constantly.

B1 Motion Reasoning

Motion-based questions show an object, shape, or scene changing across a sequence (rotating, moving position, growing/shrinking, or transforming) and ask you to predict the next state, or identify which option correctly continues the pattern.

BASIC — SINGLE-VARIABLE MOTION

- The simplest version changes ONE thing at a time — e.g., a shape rotates 90° clockwise in each frame.
- Strategy: identify the single transformation rule (rotate/flip/move/resize) by comparing frame 1 to frame 2, then verify it holds for frame 2 to frame 3.

Example (described)

Frame 1: an arrow pointing up. Frame 2: pointing right. Frame 3: pointing down. What comes next? Answer: pointing left — the arrow rotates 90° clockwise every frame, so it continues the same rotation.

INTERMEDIATE — MULTI-VARIABLE MOTION

- Harder versions change TWO or more things simultaneously — e.g., a shape both rotates AND changes size AND changes shading each frame.
- Strategy: isolate and track ONE variable across the whole sequence first (ignore the others), confirm its rule, then repeat for the next variable. Don't try to track all variables at once — this is the #1 cause of errors under time pressure.

ADVANCED — GRID-BASED MOTION (COMBINED WITH SPATIAL LOGIC)

- The hardest version places a moving/transforming object inside a grid, where its POSITION shifts according to a rule (e.g., moves one cell right and one cell down each frame, wrapping around at the edges).
- Strategy: track position using simple row/column coordinates (like a mini spreadsheet) rather than visually — this avoids losing track under time pressure.
- If the object also transforms while moving, solve position and transformation as two SEPARATE, independent sub-problems.

■ Motion Reasoning Tips & Tricks

Always check the LAST two frames' relationship, not just the first two — some sequences have a rule that only becomes clear later (e.g., alternating patterns).

If you're stuck between two answer options, check which one is consistent with EVERY frame transition, not just the most recent one.

These questions are usually heavily timed (10–20 sec each) — if you can't spot the pattern in ~15 seconds, make your best guess and move on rather than losing time on one question.

B2 Grid & Spatial Memory

This tests your ability to remember and recall positions, patterns, or sequences shown briefly on a grid — similar to a memory-matching game crossed with spatial reasoning.

BASIC — SIMPLE POSITION RECALL

- A grid (e.g., 3x3 or 4x4) briefly highlights certain cells; you must recall and re-select the same cells afterward.
- Strategy: don't try to memorize cells individually — group them into a recognizable SHAPE or PATTERN mentally (e.g., "an L-shape in the top-left" is easier to recall than "cells 1, 4, 5").

INTERMEDIATE — SEQUENCE MEMORY

- Cells light up in a specific ORDER (not just a static pattern), and you must reproduce the same sequence.
- Strategy: convert the sequence into a short verbal/mental "story" or path ("top-left, then right, then down, then down again") — verbal encoding often sticks better than pure visual memory under pressure.
- Chunk longer sequences into groups of 3–4 (like remembering a phone number in chunks) rather than one long unbroken sequence.

ADVANCED — COMBINED PATTERN + INTERFERENCE

- Advanced versions may show a DISTRACTOR pattern between the memorization phase and the recall phase (e.g., a brief unrelated task) to test true retention rather than short-term visual echo.
- Strategy: as soon as the pattern disappears, briefly rehearse it once in your head (silently repeat the sequence/shape to yourself) before any distractor appears — this converts fragile visual memory into more durable verbal/working memory.
- Stay calm if a distractor appears — panicking wipes short-term memory faster than the distractor itself does.

■ Grid & Spatial Memory Tips & Tricks

Use the "chunking" technique: break any grid pattern into 2–3 smaller recognizable groups rather than memorizing every cell individually.

Practice with real memory-game apps (any "Simon says" style grid game) for 10 minutes a day in the days before your test — this genuinely improves working memory speed.

If you're unsure of one cell in recall, don't freeze — commit to your best guess and keep going; partial credit is common in these games.

Reduce visual clutter in your own testing environment (clear desk, no other windows open) — external distractions hurt spatial memory performance more than most other question types.

B3 Logical Reasoning (All Sub-Types)

Logical reasoning covers several distinct question families. Each has its own pattern-recognition trick — learn the trick, and speed comes naturally with practice.

BASIC — NUMBER & LETTER SERIES

- Look for a consistent arithmetic pattern first: constant difference, constant ratio, or a difference-of-differences (second-order pattern).
- For letter series, convert letters to numbers (A=1, B=2...) mentally if the pattern isn't obvious visually.

Q1. Series: 2, 6, 12, 20, 30, ?

✓ **Answer: 42**

Why: Differences are 4, 6, 8, 10, 12 (increasing by 2 each time) — $30 + 12 = 42$. (This is also $n \times (n+1)$ for $n=1,2,3...$)

Q2. Series: B, D, G, K, ?

✓ **Answer: P**

Why: Gaps between letters increase by 1 each time: $B \rightarrow D (+2)$, $D \rightarrow G (+3)$, $G \rightarrow K (+4)$, $K \rightarrow P (+5)$.

BASIC — CODING-DECODING

- Identify the exact shift/rule applied to EACH letter (forward shift, backward shift, reverse alphabet mapping) using the given example first.
- Apply the identified rule mechanically to the new word — don't try to shortcut without confirming the rule on the example first.

Q3. If DELHI is coded as EFMIJ, how is MUMBAI coded using the same rule?

✓ **Answer: NVNCBJ**

Why: Each letter shifts forward by 1 ($D \rightarrow E$, $E \rightarrow F$, $L \rightarrow M$, $H \rightarrow I$, $I \rightarrow J$). Applying the same +1 shift to MUMBAI gives NVNCBJ.

INTERMEDIATE — BLOOD RELATIONS

- Draw a simple family tree diagram as you read — never solve blood relation puzzles purely mentally, even simple ones.
- Use standard symbols: + for male, - for female (or M/F), horizontal line for marriage, vertical line for parent-child.

Q4. A is B's father. B is C's sister. D is C's mother and A's wife. How is D related to B?

✓ **Answer: Mother**

Why: A (father) + D (A's wife) = parents; B and C are their children (siblings, since B is C's sister) — so D is B's mother.

INTERMEDIATE — DIRECTION SENSE

- Draw a simple compass (N/S/E/W) on scratch paper/mentally and physically trace each turn — don't try to track direction changes purely in your head for more than 2 turns.
- Remember: facing North, a 90° clockwise turn = East; a 90° anticlockwise turn = West.

Q5. Rohan walks 5 km North, then turns right and walks 3 km, then turns right again and walks 5 km. How far is he from the starting point, and in which direction?

✓ **Answer: 3 km, to the East of the starting point.**

Why: North 5km, then East 3km (right turn from North), then South 5km (right turn from East) — the two 5km legs cancel out (opposite directions), leaving only the 3km East displacement.

ADVANCED — SYLLOGISMS

- Always draw a quick Venn diagram — syllogisms are specifically designed to trick verbal/mental reasoning.
- Key trap: "All A are B" does NOT mean "All B are A" — the relationship is one-directional unless stated otherwise.
- "Some A are B" only guarantees overlap exists — it says nothing about the rest of A or B.

Q6. Statements: All roses are flowers. Some flowers are red. Conclusion: Some roses are red.

Follows Does not follow

✓ **Answer: Does not follow**

Why: The 'red flowers' subset might not overlap with the 'rose' subset at all — the two statements don't guarantee that specific overlap. Classic syllogism trap.

Q7. Statements: No cats are dogs. All dogs are animals. Conclusion: Some animals are not cats.

Follows Does not follow

✓ **Answer: Follows**

Why: Since dogs are animals, and no dogs are cats, at least the dogs (which are animals) are not cats — this guarantees the conclusion.

ADVANCED — SEATING ARRANGEMENT & PUZZLES

- Draw the seating layout (circle/row/table) immediately and place confirmed positions first, before working through relative clues.
- Work through clues in order of certainty — absolute clues ("X sits at position 3") first, then relative clues ("Y sits to the left of X") next, and clues with 'or'/uncertainty last.
- If a clue creates a contradiction with a placed position, backtrack immediately rather than continuing forward with an error.

■ Logical Reasoning — General Tips & Tricks

Always externalize your reasoning (quick diagram/notes) rather than solving in your head — this is the single biggest speed AND accuracy improvement across ALL logical reasoning types.

In a timed test, if a question type feels unfamiliar, do a very quick self-check: what FAMILY does this belong to (series/coding/blood relation/syllogism/seating)? — this alone often unlocks the right method.

Practice 15–20 mixed questions daily in the days before your test rather than 100 questions of just one type — the real test mixes types, so your brain needs to switch between methods quickly.

B4 Behavioural / Situational Judgement

This assesses how you'd act in realistic workplace situations. There's rarely one 'perfect' answer, but responses are scored against traits employers value — so understanding the SCORING LOGIC matters more than memorizing answers.

BASIC — WHAT'S BEING MEASURED

Trait	What it looks like in an answer
Ownership/Accountability	Taking responsibility rather than blaming others or circumstances
Collaboration	Involving/consulting others rather than acting unilaterally
Adaptability	Adjusting approach when plans change, rather than rigidly sticking to one path
Client/Stakeholder focus	Prioritizing the end-user's or client's needs in the decision
Integrity	Being honest even when it's inconvenient (e.g., admitting a mistake)
Proactive communication	Flagging issues early rather than waiting until they escalate

INTERMEDIATE — AVOIDING COMMON TRAPS

- Avoid EXTREME options — "always" doing X or "never" doing Y usually signals an unrealistic, performative answer rather than genuine judgment.
- Avoid options that solve the problem by escalating immediately without trying anything yourself first (unless the scenario is genuinely urgent/serious).
- Avoid answers that ignore the team/other people entirely — even independent-sounding tasks usually score better with some acknowledgment of collaboration.

ADVANCED — MULTI-STAKEHOLDER SCENARIOS

Harder scenarios involve competing priorities (e.g., your manager wants X, but the client is asking for Y). The strongest answers usually: (1) acknowledge both sides briefly, (2) propose a concrete way to reconcile or escalate appropriately, and (3) avoid picking one side dismissively.

B4.4 Sample Practice Scenarios

Q1. You notice a mistake in a report that has already been sent to a client by a teammate. What do you do?

(A) Ignore it since it's not your report (B) Quietly fix it yourself without telling anyone (C) Inform your teammate/manager promptly so it can be corrected with the client (D) Wait to see if the client notices first

✓ **Answer: (C)**

Why: This shows both integrity and proactive communication — flagging the issue promptly allows for a proper correction, rather than hiding it (B), ignoring it (A/D), or letting the client discover an error unaddressed.

Q2. Your manager asks you to prioritize a new task, but it will delay a commitment you already made to a colleague. What do you do?

(A) Do the new task and don't mention the delay to your colleague (B) Refuse the manager's request to protect your existing commitment (C) Inform both parties of the conflict and propose a realistic revised timeline (D) Try to do both simultaneously without telling either party there's a risk

✓ **Answer: (C)**

Why: This balances accountability to both parties through transparent communication, rather than silently disappointing one side (A) or outright refusing your manager (B) or risking a hidden failure (D).

Q3. You're unsure how to complete a task correctly and the deadline is approaching. What's the best approach?

(A) Guess and submit something rather than ask for help (B) Ask a colleague or manager for clarification as soon as you realize you're unsure (C) Wait until the last moment hoping it becomes clearer (D) Skip the task entirely

✓ **Answer: (B)**

Why: Asking early shows proactive communication and prevents a bigger problem later — waiting (C), guessing (A), or skipping (D) all risk a worse outcome that was avoidable.

■ Behavioural / SJT Tips & Tricks

When two options both seem reasonable, pick the one that involves clear COMMUNICATION over one that involves silent, solo action.

Don't overthink or try to guess a 'hidden trick' — go with your genuine, professional first instinct; these tests are usually timed and reward natural judgment over second-guessing.

Be internally consistent — if you pick 'always communicate proactively' in one question, don't pick an option in another question that contradicts that same value; inconsistent patterns can be flagged.

Avoid picking the most passive AND the most aggressive extremes — balanced, assertive-but-collaborative answers consistently score best.

B5 Other Common Cognitive Games

Beyond Motion, Grid Memory, Logical Reasoning, and Behavioural, cognitive assessment platforms often include a few more short game-style rounds. Here's how to handle the most common ones if they appear.

Pattern Recognition / Odd-One-Out

- You're shown 4–5 items (shapes, numbers, words) and must identify which one doesn't share the common rule with the others.
- Strategy: find the rule connecting the majority FIRST (usually 3 out of 4/5 items), then the odd one out is whichever breaks that specific rule.

Speed Matching / Symbol Recognition

- Quickly match symbols, numbers, or colors against a key, often under a tight timer.
- Strategy: don't try to memorize the whole key at once — glance at the key for each item individually rather than trying to hold it all in memory, unless the key is very short.
- Accuracy over speed initially — a few careless errors from rushing usually cost more than a slightly slower, careful pace.

Working Memory / N-Back Style Games

- You must recall whether the current item matches one shown N steps earlier in a continuous stream.
- Strategy: keep a mental 'sliding window' of just the last N items rather than trying to remember the whole sequence — refresh this window after every new item.

Risk/Decision-Making Games

- Some platforms include a simple gambling-style or resource-allocation game measuring risk tolerance and decision consistency under uncertainty.
- Strategy: there's usually no single 'correct' risk level being tested — focus on being CONSISTENT with a moderate, reasoned approach rather than wildly swinging between very safe and very risky choices.

■ General Tips for Any Unfamiliar Cognitive Game

Read/watch the instructions and any practice round carefully — these games often have a short tutorial round that doesn't count toward your score; use it to fully understand the mechanic before the real one starts.

Don't let one bad round affect the next — these games usually score each round independently, so a mistake early on is not worth dwelling on.

If a game is new to you, prioritize UNDERSTANDING THE RULE correctly over speed for the first couple of questions, then speed up once you're confident.

FINAL 7-Day Practice Routine & Master Checklist

Use this focused routine to cover both parts of this guide efficiently in the days you have before your tests.

Day	English Communication focus	Cognitive/Game-based focus
Day 1	Grammar basic + intermediate rules; do the practice set	Motion reasoning — practice 10 sequence questions
Day 2	Reading comprehension: 1 passage + full question set	Grid/spatial memory — 10 min of memory-game practice
Day 3	Listening: 15 min of audio practice with note-taking	Logical reasoning — series, coding-decoding practice
Day 4	Speaking: record 5 answers using the 3-part structure	Logical reasoning — blood relations, direction sense
Day 5	Formal + informal email: write 2 of each from scratch	Logical reasoning — syllogisms, seating arrangement
Day 6	Sentence completion + statement-conclusion practice set	Behavioural — read through sample scenarios and reasoning
Day 7	Full mixed mock: one of each English question type, timed	Full mixed cognitive mock — one of each game type, timed

Master Checklist

- ■ Comfortable with all 6 core tenses and can spot subject-verb agreement errors quickly.
- ■ Can identify main idea, inference, and vocabulary-in-context questions in a reading passage confidently.
- ■ Practiced listening with note-taking at least 3 times.
- ■ Recorded and reviewed at least 5 spoken answers using the 3-part structure.
- ■ Written at least 2 formal and 2 informal emails from scratch (not just read samples).
- ■ Comfortable distinguishing 'follows' vs 'does not follow' in statement-conclusion questions.
- ■ Practiced at least 15–20 mixed logical reasoning questions across different sub-types.
- ■ Tried at least one grid/memory-game style practice exercise.
- ■ Reviewed the behavioural trait table and thought through how you'd genuinely answer each sample scenario.

■ Final Reminder

Every sub-skill in this guide rewards the same underlying habit: **externalize your thinking** — speak your full answer out loud for English tasks, and jot quick notes/diagrams for logical and memory tasks — rather than trying to solve everything silently in your head. This single habit change improves both speed and accuracy across nearly every section covered here. Good luck!